

tion works on the Gyndes (as Sir H. Rawlinson, *ad loc.*). The form it takes is religious in colouring; 'white horses' were sacred to the sun (iii. 90. 3 n.; cf. vii. 40. 4); hence the offending river is divided into as many channels (360) as there are days in the year.

190 I The war lasted longer than H. thinks; it perhaps began in 546 B.C., as the annals of Nabonidus seem to speak of an attack on Akkad (i.e. N. Babylonia) from Elam in that year (R. P. v². 161); but the record is much mutilated.

2 προεσάξαντο. The use of this word in viii. 20. 1 seems to show that it is from προσάπτω, 'they packed up beforehand,' not from προεσάγω (as Schweighäuser); cf. v. 34. 1 n.

191 2 ἅπασαν. Used loosely for 'the main army', as two other contingents are at once mentioned.

3 ἕλος. Cf. 185. 4, 5 nn.

ὑπονοστήσαντος, 'when the river had sunk' (cf. iv. 62. 2).

6 For Aristotle's account of the capture of Babylon, which even exaggerates the one here, cf. 178. 2 n.

ὁρτήν. The 'feast' agrees with the well-known story in Dan. v. πρῶτον. H. calls it 'the first' capture, in contrast to that by Darius (iii. 158). No doubt, however, he heard in Babylon nothing of Assyrian captures, e.g. by Assurbanipal in 648 B.C.

192-200 The account of the Babylonian land and people.

192 I τροφήν. This general payment in kind is not mentioned in iii. 90-5; the only corn contribution there (91. 3) is that of Egypt. The omission of the corn-tax in Bk. III goes to show (what is antecedently probable) that H. is there quoting an official document, drawn up for one special purpose, not giving an account of the whole revenue system. The corn contribution here mentioned corresponds to the Roman (1) *frumentum in cellam* (for the governor and his suite); but this was paid for; (2) *annona militaris* (for the soldiers in the province); (3) *annona civica*, i.e. for Rome, from Egypt and Africa (Marquardt, Staats-V. ii. 189, 232-3). For contributions in kind in Persia cf. Theop. frs. 124-5 (F. H. G. i. 298) and Meyer, iii. 51.

2 For the use of Ἀσσυρίη cf. 178. 1 n. For σατραπήν cf. iii. 89. 1 n. This Tritantæchmes, who was clearly satrap of Babylon when H. was there, is to be distinguished from the nephew of Darius (vii. 82); for his father Artabazus cf. viii. 126 and ix. *pass.*

3 As the μέδιμνος held 48 χοίνικες, the 'artaba' held 51, i.e. about 13 gallons. A χοίνιξ of wheat was a man's daily allowance, vii. 187. 2. For its size cf. vi. 57 n.

4 For the hunting dogs see Rawlinson, *ad loc.* (with illustration). Ctesias (Ind. 5, p. 248) says they were able to cope with a lion, a characteristic exaggeration. M. Polo (ii. 19; i. 400) says the Great Khan had about 10,000 hunting dogs.

193 1 H. is describing the Babylonian plain proper, i.e. the southern